Module 1
Introduction to What Is Contemporary Art?

Module 2
Media from Television to the Internet

Module 3
Territories & Transit

Module 4
Materials & Making

Module 5
Agency

Visibility
- Introduction to Module 5 — Reading • 10 min
- Pope.L's New York crawls — Reading • 10 min
- In New York City with Pope.L | Direct action — Video • 4 min
- Two artists consider Catherine Opie, Dyke, 1993 — Video • 2 min
- Tania Bruguera on Untitled (Havana, 2000), 2000 — Video • 4 min
- Luis Camnitzer on Memorial, 2009 — Video • 2 min
- Yara Said on the Refugee Flag, 2016 — Reading • 10 min
- Firelei Báez on For Améthyste and Athénaïre (Exiled Muses Beyond Jean Luc Nancy's Canon), Anacaonas, 2018 — Reading • 10 min

Voice
- Who speaks? — Reading • 10 min
- Nick Cave on Soundsuit, 2011 — Video • 2 min
- Lawrence Abu Hamdan, Conflicted Phonemes, 2012 — Reading • 10 min
- P Staff on Weed Killer, 2017 — Reading • 10 min

Action
- Taking action — Reading • 10 min
- Lorraine O'Grady on Mlle Bourgeoise Noire, 1980–83/2009 — Video • 2 min
- Xiao Lu on Dialogue, 1989 — Video • 2 min
- Ralph Borland, Suited for Subversion (Prototype), 2002 — Video • 1 min
- **Defining and blurring identities through performance** — Reading • 10 min

Review & Respond
- Memory Check — Practice Assignment
- Reflect on Agency in Module 5 — Dialogue • 15 min
- Optional Readings & Resources — Reading • 10 min

Module 6
Power

Exposing Power
- Introduction to Module 6 — Reading • 10 min
- Instructor Christian Rattemeyer on Mark Lombardi's diagrams of power — Video • 6 min
- What do war and peace have to do with chandeliers and portraits? — Reading • 10 min
- Deana Lawson on Nation, 2017 — Video • 2 min

Abuse of Power
- How do artists critique power? — Reading • 10 min
- Two responses to abuse of power — Reading • 10 min
- Wolfgang Tillmans on Sendeschluss / End of Broadcast I, 2014 — Video • 2 min

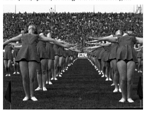
Sources of Power
- Power: sources and resources — Reading • 10 min
- Outer space to inner earth — Reading • 10 min
- Curator Paola Antonelli on Massoud Hassani's Mine Kafon wind-powered deminer, 2011 — Video • 1 min
- Rania Ghosn on After Oil, 2016 — Video • 4 min

Review & Respond
- Memory Check — Practice Assignment
- Reflecting on Power in Art — Dialogue • 15 min
- Final course reflection — Graded Assignment • 30 min
- Optional Readings & Resources — Reading • 10 min
- End-of-course survey — Reading • 5 min
- Recordings of live virtual sessions (optional) — Reading • 10 min
- MoMA Resources — Reading • 10 min

Defining and blurring identities through performance

1:54 / 2:54 1x

Marta Popivoda, *Yugoslavia, How Ideology Moved Our Collective Body*, 2013



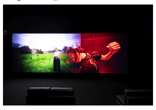
Marta Popivoda. Still from *Yugoslavia, How Ideology Moved Our Collective Body*. 2013. Video (color, sound). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Purchase from the artist

Editing together film and video footage from the Socialist Federal Republic of Yugoslavia (1945–2000), Marta Popivoda examines collectivist ideology and its dissolution in *Yugoslavia, How Ideology Moved Our Collective Body*. The video opens with children pledging to be model citizens of the Republic. In a voice-over, Popivoda reflects on making this pledge herself: "It was a detail from my childhood…. But many years later the image caught me." This sets the personal tone with which she reviews three generations of history.

Masses of people fill every frame of Popivoda's video. "Their bodies are matrices in which ideas of collectivism get shaped," she observes—a point made clear in the footage of the rallies, marches, and choreographed Youth Day performances that reinforced socialist ideals. But scenes of student and civic demonstrations in 1968 and the 1990s reveal discontent beneath the surface.

Watch the trailer for *Yugoslavia, How Ideology Moved Our Collective Body*.

Wu Tsang, *We hold where study*, 2017



Wu Tsang. *We hold where study*. 2017. Two-channel video (color, sound). 18:56 min. Excerpt: one minute. The Museum of Modern Art, New York. The Modern Women's Fund. © 2020 Wu Tsang

Choreography: Ligia Lewis with Jonathan Gonzalez; boychild with Josh Johnson. Music: Bendik Giske. Performers: boychild, Jonathan Gonzalez, Josh Johnson, Ligia Lewis, and Julian and Lorenzo Moten. Cinematography: Antonio Cisneros. Voice-over: Fred Moten. Editor: Wu Tsang. Commissioned by Polyeco Contemporary Art Initiative

Wu Tsang has said of her own experience as a trans woman of color: "We either are fighting to be seen, or we are invisible, or we refuse being seen….There are so many other ways of existing and making images outside of that." In her color saturated video installation *We hold where study*, she presents a different vision.

Tsang collaborated with two pairs of performers who engage with each other through contact improvisation, a form of movement based on a give-and-take of action and response. One pair inhabits a grassy clearing, the other a dance studio. They bring their bodies together, wrench them apart, fall down, send their arms flying outward in choreography centered on bodily contact, which ranges from tender and sensual to rough, almost violent. Tsang alternates between showing one pair at a time and both pairs in overlapping projections, emphasizing their interconnectedness and fluidity.

Watch an excerpt of *We hold where study*.

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